ORANGE UNIVERSITY

ver. 20261102-093408

ASSESSMENT 2 BRIEF: COMPARATIVE FRUIT ANALYSIS

Assessment	Comparative Fruit Analysis
Individual/Group	Individual
Length	1200-word report with comparison table
Learning Outcomes	• (d) Share a brief write-up that compares two different fruits and what makes each one unique in presentation and flavor. • (e) Compare and contrast tropical fruits using structured observation frameworks and sensory analysis. • (f) Apply basic preservation techniques and document changes in fruit characteristics over time.
Submission	Due by 23h55 GMT on the final Friday of the learning block
Weighting	35%
Total Marks	100

TASK SUMMARY

Write a 1200-word comparative report analysing two tropical fruits using structured observation frameworks. Your report should include a comparison table, sensory descriptions, and a reflection on how preservation methods affect each fruit's characteristics.

CONTEXT

Comparing fruits side by side reveals patterns that single observations might miss. This assessment builds on the catalogue skills you developed in Assessment 1 by asking you to go deeper: how do two fruits differ in structure, flavour development, and response to preservation? Structured comparison is a fundamental skill in food science, botany, and product development, and it sharpens your ability to notice and articulate subtle differences.

TASK INSTRUCTIONS

1. **Select two tropical fruits** that share some characteristics but differ in others (e.g., mango vs papaya, lychee vs rambutan, jackfruit vs durian).
2. **Observe and document** each fruit using the sensory framework introduced in Modules 4-6. Record appearance, aroma, texture, flavour profile, and structural features.
3. **Create a comparison table** with at least six dimensions (e.g., skin texture, flesh colour, sweetness level, acidity, seed structure, seasonal availability).
4. **Apply one preservation method** to a sample of each fruit (drying, freezing, or sugar preservation) and document the before-and-after characteristics with photographs and notes.
5. **Write a 1200-word report** structured as follows:
   - Introduction (150 words): rationale for your fruit selection
   - Individual profiles (300 words each): detailed sensory descriptions
   - Comparison section (300 words): analysis using your comparison table
   - Preservation reflection (150 words): how each fruit responded to preservation

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SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

Submit a single PDF document containing your report, comparison table, and before-and-after photographs. Name your file `ass_02_comparative_analysis.pdf` and upload to the LMS submission portal.

REFERENCING

Use APA 7th edition referencing. A minimum of four sources is expected, drawn from the module readings and your own research. Include in-text citations and a reference list.

AI Policy

AI supports your learning, it does not replace your intellectual work. You are accountable for understanding and explaining all submitted material. Implicitly claiming AI-generated content as your own work constitutes academic misconduct and insufficient authorship.

Writing

- **Permitted:** AI for brainstorming, drafting ideas, refining phrasing, and checking grammar or clarity. Crucial: Critically evaluate, modify, and fully understand any AI output you integrate into your work.

- **Prohibited:** Submitting AI-generated text without thorough mental parsing and comprehension. Ask yourself: If interviewed, can you explain every choice and observation in your own words?

Visuals

- **Permitted:** AI for inspiration, mood boards, layout ideas, colour suggestions, and rough visual concepts. Crucial: Adapt, refine, justify, and understand any AI-assisted visual choices you include.
- **Prohibited:** Submitting AI-generated images or designs as your own without meaningful revision and understanding. Ask yourself: If interviewed, can you explain your visual decisions and how each element supports your work?

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY DECLARATION

I declare that, except where I have referenced, the work I am submitting for this assessment task is my own work. I have read and am aware of my institution's Academic Integrity Policy and Procedure.

I am aware that I need to keep a copy of all submitted material and its drafts, and I will do so accordingly.

ASSESSMENT RUBRIC

Assessment Attributes	Fail *0–49%*	Pass *50–64%*	Credit *65–74%*	Distinction *75–84%*	High Distinct. *85–100%*
Sensory Description *30%*	Descriptions vague or absent; little evidence of observation.	Basic descriptions present but lack specificity or sensory detail.	Clear descriptions capture appearance, aroma, texture, and flavour.	Rich, evocative descriptions that make both fruits vividly imaginable.	Exceptional sensory writing; descriptions are precise, layered, and memorable.
Comparison Table *20%*	Table missing or incomplete; dimensions are superficial.	Table present but dimensions are uneven or poorly justified.	Table covers six dimensions with accurate, well-organised data.	Table is comprehensive and includes insightful comparative notes.	Table demonstrates sophisticated analysis with nuanced, well-justified dimensions.
Preservation Reflection *20%*	Preservation attempt absent or undocumented.	Basic before-and-after notes with minimal analysis.	Clear documentation of changes with thoughtful reflection.	Detailed documentation showing understanding of preservation principles.	Insightful analysis connecting preservation outcomes to fruit structure and composition.
Report Structure & Writing *20%*	Disorganised; significant errors in grammar or formatting.	Adequate structure but some sections underdeveloped.	Well-organised report with clear sections and competent writing.	Polished writing with logical flow and engaging style.	Professional-quality writing; clear, compelling, and meticulously edited.
Referencing *10%*	No references or entirely incorrect format.	Some sources cited but formatting inconsistent.	Four sources correctly cited in APA 7th edition.	Sources well-integrated into the argument; correct formatting throughout.	Sources enrich the analysis and demonstrate broader research engagement.